Silky Roasted Tomato Soup

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

We love tomato soup at home, and this is one the kids ask for again and again.

Serves 4 · Prep 10 min · Cook 50 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SOUP

- 1 kg tomatoes, halved or quartered
- 1 medium onion, peeled and cut into wedges
- 1 red capsicum, deseeded and cut into large pieces
- 1 red chilli, optional
- A small bunch of fresh basil, or 1 tbsp dried basil
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp salt, adjusted to taste
- A splash of cooking cream

FOR THE CHEESE TOASTIES

- 8 slices of toast bread or sourdough
- Cheddar cheese, sliced or grated
- Mozzarella, gouda or emmental, sliced or grated
- A little butter, for the outside of the bread

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C conventional / 180°C fan.
2. Place the tomatoes, onion, capsicum and optional chilli on a large roasting tray. Drizzle with the olive oil, sprinkle with salt and toss to coat.
3. Roast for 35–45 minutes, until the vegetables are very soft and lightly caramelised around the edges.
4. Add the basil for the last 5 minutes, gently tucking fresh leaves into the vegetables and their juices to prevent burning.
5. Allow the vegetables to cool slightly, then pour everything, including all the roasting juices, into a blender suitable for warm ingredients. Blend until silky and smooth, working in batches and following the blender's instructions for venting. Alternatively, transfer everything to a saucepan and blend thoroughly with a hand blender.
6. Pour the blended soup into a saucepan. Stir in a splash of cooking cream and warm gently without boiling. Taste and adjust the salt.
7. To make the toasties, fill the bread with cheddar and your choice of mozzarella, gouda or emmental. Lightly butter the outside of each sandwich.
8. Cook in a frying pan over medium-low heat, turning once, until the bread is golden and crisp and the cheese has melted. Alternatively, use a sandwich press.
9. Cut the toasties in half and serve immediately alongside the warm soup.

Tip

Choose ripe, flavourful tomatoes. They are the heart of the soup and make all the difference to its taste.